

LEE GILBERT

for Boulder City Council

Balance safety AND traffic flow. Use real data. Ask residents first.

A vote for me is a vote of “No Confidence” in how Boulder plans and builds major road projects.

The Problem

Boulder is spending millions redesigning roads that people don't want — without checking crash data or asking the public. The City Council rubber-stamps projects instead of providing critical review.

What Went Wrong on Baseline

- **The data was ignored.** The Baseline redesign was justified as a bike-safety project — yet the stretch from 32nd to Mohawk had just 2 bicycle accidents in 7 years (only one with “possible injury”). Nearly all Baseline bike crashes happen elsewhere, west of the project.
- **The design created new problems.** Days after Baseline and Mohawk was redesigned, a 67-year-old cyclist hit striped speed bumps, suffering a concussion and a broken sacrum. Narrowed side streets now cause congestion for neighborhoods that didn't exist before.
- **The city stopped showing its work.** Boulder built a public Crash Dashboard in 2022, then quietly removed a link to it and then stopped updating it — making it harder for anyone to check whether these projects actually work.
- **The results aren't there.** After a decade of Vision Zero, severe-injury and fatal crashes haven't fallen — 55 in 2013, 55 in 2023.

What I'll Do

- **Pause new major road projects** until each is re-evaluated against goals that balance safety and efficient traffic flow — weighing the risks of new designs, not just their promised benefits.
- **Require real local data.** Reactivate and expand the Crash Dashboard, add a “close-call” reporting system, and target fixes where accidents actually happen.
- **Demand public buy-in.** Neighborhoods should be consulted and major projects voted on.
- **Designs should be checked on-site** to see how people really use them.
- **Fix what's not working.** Roll back the least-justified changes of the Baseline Project, restore traffic lanes on Baseline east of Foothills, return “Bus Only” lanes to normal traffic lanes, and stop using flashing-yellow left-turn arrows where pedestrians or cyclists cross.
- **Favor simple, visible design.** Good roads shouldn't need a forest of bollards. Prioritize clear markings, good maintenance, and intuitive layouts.

About Lee: Long-time Boulder resident, attended CU and receiving degrees in electrical engineering. Additional experience in statistics and failure analysis. He's lived near Baseline for decades and does most local errands on foot or by bike.

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